



MAIN STREET IQ

Financial IQ for Main Street

Wine Country Intelligence

Wine Country Intelligence Report

Santa Barbara County

Q3 2026 Edition | 169 Wineries Evaluated

Prepared by
Scott Hess, Main Street IQ
scott@mainstreetiq.com
October 9, 2026

This is a sample. It is the Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County edition with every winery replaced by an invented one: the names, towns, scores, ranks and AI figures of individual wineries are illustrative, so no row describes a real winery. The county figures, the market section, our calls and the method are as published, except the highest score and each town's top score, which follow the invented wineries. A blank town is withheld or not listed. The full county edition names every winery we measure, with its real figures.

A Letter from Scott

I have spent a good portion of 2026 visiting tasting rooms, cellars and offices across Santa Barbara and San Luis Obispo counties. I have sat down with nearly 100 winemakers, owners, investors and people who work around this industry, and I'm now fortunate to count several of those wineries as clients.

Everyone I talk to wants to grow. Not everyone wants to grow the same way. One winery's license will not let it pour by the glass, so it lives on bottles and club. Another does most of its business by the glass. Another opens on weekends to pour and talk, and \$750,000 a year is exactly the business its owner wants. These are different businesses with different strategies, and the help on offer, from vendors and sometimes from the organizations that serve the region, too often arrives as one approach for all of them.

That matters more now, because the market is changing under every one of them. Grapes fetch less a ton, growers statewide are pulling vines, and more visitors seem to ask an AI assistant where to taste before they ask anyone else. I do not think that pressure lands evenly. Over the next year this report will look at which business models hold up and which feel the squeeze, starting with the direct-to-visitor side we measure today and widening to wholesale, which we have barely touched.

What follows is what we measured this quarter.

Scott Hess

The One Thing That Mattered This Quarter

Since Q2 2026, 22 Santa Barbara wineries were named by AI less often, and 8 more often

We asked AI assistants the same 12 questions about Santa Barbara County as last quarter. Of the 155 wineries we measured both times, 22 came up less often and 8 more often, each by at least as much as our own rounds of asking differ. About as many wineries were named overall; what changed is which ones. Across all 75 prompts we ask now, 153 of the 169 wineries we measure came up at least once, and 16 never did.

Why it matters: An AI assistant hands a visitor a shortlist, and its answer changes from one ask to the next. The goal is to be on it every time, which is why we ask each question three times.

If you do one thing with this report before reading further, do this: open ChatGPT or Gemini, ask it where to taste in your own valley, and look for your name in the answer. It takes two minutes and it will tell you more about how findable you are right now than any ranking on the pages that follow.

Our Calls, Scored

First edition: nothing to score yet. This is the first edition to make calls. Our first two are at the end of this edition, in Our Calls for Next Quarter. The Q4 2026 edition scores them here, Right, Wrong or Too early, misses included, before it claims anything else.

What Moved

About as many wineries were named by AI in Santa Barbara as last quarter

About as many wineries were named as last quarter, on the same 12 questions. The difference is smaller than the difference between our own three rounds of asking, so we can't call it a change. How We Measure gives the counts.

Why it matters: The total held, so the news is not the total. It is which wineries moved inside it, below.

Biggest movers: 8 wineries came up more often in AI answers and 22 less often

We asked the same 12 questions per county as last quarter, three times each. Of the 155 wineries we measured both times, 8 came up in more answers than in Q2 2026 and 22 in fewer. We count a winery only when all three rounds this quarter agree and the change is at least as big as the difference between our rounds and is at least two answers. The other 125 moved by less than that. Each figure is the number of answers that named the winery, out of the 48 answers its county's questions drew in each round. The tables list the largest moves each way, with every winery tied at the last place shown.

Largest gains

Winery	Town	Q2 2026	This quarter
Senara Vineyards	Los Olivos	7 of 48	11 to 15 of 48
Pelette Vineyards	Lompoc	2 of 48	3 to 5 of 48
Dorvana Vineyards	Santa Barbara	5 of 48	7 to 8 of 48
Orvessa Winery	Santa Maria	4 of 48	5 to 6 of 48
Sundova Winery	Buellton	1 of 48	2 to 3 of 48
Stintova Vineyards	Santa Maria	3 of 48	4 to 5 of 48
Misance Estate	Los Olivos	4 of 48	5 to 6 of 48
Boldona Wine Co.	Lompoc	4 of 48	5 to 6 of 48

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Largest declines

Winery	Town	Q2 2026	This quarter
Halvora Winery	Santa Maria	16 of 48	7 to 12 of 48
Lervino Winery	Santa Ynez	11 of 48	4 to 7 of 48
Brusette Winery	Lompoc	26 of 48	19 to 21 of 48
Vuldeau Vineyards	Santa Barbara	27 of 48	20 to 23 of 48
Stuneau Vineyards	Los Olivos	14 of 48	8 to 10 of 48
Kelvane Estate	Los Olivos	9 of 48	4 to 5 of 48
Broltory Cellars	Buellton	11 of 48	6 to 9 of 48
Vusello Vineyards	Santa Ynez	16 of 48	11 to 14 of 48

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample.

Broltory Cellars came up less often on these 12 questions and is still among the fifteen wineries named most often in Santa Barbara County across all the questions we ask. There is no contradiction: the two counts cover different questions.

Most of the fall came from two of the four assistants. Across the 22 wineries that came up less often, the number of times one of them was named, counting each winery in each answer, went from 206 in Q2 2026 to 133 in the middle of our three rounds, a drop of 73; Perplexity and Gemini account for 63 of those 73. They are the two that searched the web for every answer. GPT-4o mini and Claude, as we ask them these questions, answer from what they already know without searching. That points to a change in what those searches now find, not necessarily at the wineries.

What the wineries that rose did differently isn't visible from outside. Wineries with more Google reviews are named more often. That doesn't prove reviews cause it, but it's the strongest link in our data.

Did the websites the assistants cite change for these wineries? We can't tell yet. Last quarter's answers were stored without a usable list of sources: Perplexity kept no list of the pages it cited; Gemini kept only Google redirect links, which no longer open and do not show which site was cited. Claude and GPT-4o mini answered without searching, so they cite nothing in either quarter. This quarter we kept the sources for all 72 answers from Perplexity and Gemini on these questions, so the next edition can compare what was cited before and after.

Why it matters: If yours came up less often, the answer a visitor gets about your county changed, whether or not anything changed at your winery.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

73 wineries rose in the county order and 80 fell, under a new ruler

Among the 155 wineries in both editions, 73 rose in position, 80 fell and 2 held. On a scale where 1 means nobody moved and 0 means last quarter's order told you nothing about this one, the two orders score 0.84: much the same order, with real movement inside it. The ruler changed between them: Q2 2026 scored six dimensions under our earlier rubric and this edition scores seven categories under rubric v3.1, so we never compare points, and part of every move in position is the change in what we measure. How We Measure sets out each change and the reason for it.

Why it matters: Read your own move against your neighbors' rather than as a verdict on your work. Next quarter, with two editions on one ruler, a move in position will mean more.

14 wineries joined our census and 12 left it

Since the Q2 2026 edition our census of Santa Barbara County went from 171 active wineries to 172. Of the 12 that left, 4 closed and 8 no longer fit the list, which counts each winery brand once and only wineries of their own in the county that sell direct to the public. One more name on last quarter's list was a former name of a winery also on it; we count that winery once, under its current name.

Why it matters: A closure says something about the market; a winery leaving because it no longer fits our list says something about the list. Every comparison above is drawn only on wineries in both editions, so neither moves a figure in this section.

The Market Around You

What's Happening in Santa Barbara

Santa Barbara County's wine grapes were worth \$87.8 million in 2025, up 24% on 2024, according to the county crop report published this June [1]. The county is ocean-influenced and cool-climate, with Pinot Noir and Chardonnay across the Sta. Rita Hills, Santa Ynez Valley, and Santa Maria Valley, most of it within a short drive of the rest. That is the good news. The harder news is that a strong region does not automatically make any single winery easy to find, and many visitors now decide where to taste long before they arrive.

The grape market in Santa Barbara County

The crop report credits that 2025 value to higher yields on fewer harvested acres, together with strong market demand for high-quality grapes: 10,649 acres picked in 2025, down from 12,126 in 2024. Harvested acres are the vines actually picked that year. USDA's 2025 grape acreage report counts something wider, the wine-grape acres growers report standing, including young vines not yet bearing, and puts the county at 14,854 acres, down only 0.9%, against 3.7% statewide on the same basis.

Prices are the hard part. USDA's Final Grape Crush report, which records the average price paid per ton, puts District 8, the state's grape pricing district for San Luis Obispo, Santa Barbara and Ventura counties, at \$1,751.14 a ton for the 2025 crop, down 6.9% from \$1,881.03 for the 2024 crop, against a 3.9% fall statewide. Reds took the cut, down 8.6%; whites held, up 0.3%. Allied Grape Growers, as reported by the Associated Press, estimates that about half of California's 2026 crop went into harvest without a buyer contract, against 70 to 80% contracted in a typical year. We found no published count for the county.

Fruit is a buyer's market this year. A winery that buys grapes has room to secure better fruit or longer terms, and an estate with surplus fruit has more reason to bottle it and sell it direct, which is the part of the business the rest of this report measures.

Sources for this part: USDA NASS, California Grape Crush Report, Final 2025 (April 30, 2026); USDA NASS, California Grape Acreage Report, 2025 Crop (April 29, 2026); Santa Barbara County Agricultural Commissioner, Crop & Livestock Report 2025 (June 23, 2026); Associated Press, "Farmers toil to sell grapes as wine demand drops" (September 27, 2026).

Santa Barbara County's wineries are also paying for their own marketing. The county's Wine Improvement District told the Board of Supervisors on September 1, 2026, in its annual report, that the "Let's Go!" campaign for Southern California reached more than 16 million consumers and generated 138,000 website clicks, bringing about 66,000 new visitors to the website in two months [2]. Those are visitors to a website, not to tasting rooms. If your tasting room pays the assessment, it is worth asking the district how that traffic reaches the visitors who book with you.

The Central Coast Right Now

We think the COVID years, when tasting rooms were full and wine clubs swelled, were a gift that many in the industry mistook for a trend, and we do not expect those conditions back. Silicon Valley Bank's 2026 State of the Wine Industry report puts the fall in national wine sales at 2% by volume in 2025, part of a decline that began in late 2017 [3]. Its 2026 Direct-to-Consumer report finds tasting room reservations about 2% below the year before in the twelve months to March 2026, and tasting fees, roughly double what they were in 2018, no longer climbing: Napa reserve tastings now average \$125, and the share of wineries cutting their fees doubled last year, to 15.5% [4]. Those national figures set the price and the traffic every tasting room here competes on.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Younger consumers drink less, spread across more kinds of drinks, and show a lower baseline preference for wine [3]. Reading the same report, we think the wineries treating DTC as a relationship channel, not simply a point of sale, are the ones holding up.

That Napa figure is where the Central Coast has an opening. Tastings here cost a fraction of what a Napa reserve tasting now averages, and we think that accessibility is the region's real edge. But it only helps if visitors can find you, and the way they find you has changed.

AI Is Changing How You Get Found

Some visitors now plan their wine country trips by asking an AI assistant instead of searching Google. They type questions like "I'm going to Santa Ynez this weekend, where should I taste?" or "best wineries near Solvang for a group", and we think many follow the assistant's shortlist.

This differs from search ranking. AI tools do not simply return a list of links; they synthesize reviews, press mentions, blog coverage, and web content into specific, named recommendations. A winery that ranks well on Google can be absent from AI results, and the wineries winning here are not always the same ones winning in traditional search.

Most wineries likely haven't reckoned with this shift yet. A visitor who asks an AI assistant where to taste is likely to choose from what it names, and the assistant builds that answer from what it can read: your reviews, your listings, the lists and press that name you, and your own pages. That is why the score in this report is built around those signals, and why it comes second: it measures the signals our data ties to being named, and the section on who AI recommends measures the result.

Many visitors likely decide where to taste before they leave the house: checking Google reviews, scanning Instagram, reading TripAdvisor, and more and more often asking an AI assistant for recommendations.

Who's Coming and Why They Choose You

Visitors come for the wine, the food, and the experience. Most are probably not studying AVA maps; they want a great afternoon with some education thrown in.

The closest recent survey of how visitors to this coast decide was done for San Luis Obispo County's tourism bureau, Visit SLO CAL: an online survey by Heart + Mind Strategies of 3,000 travelers across California and key fly markets in July and August 2025 [5]. Nearly 4 in 5 of San Luis Obispo County's visitors are repeat visitors and 69% booked within one month; for travelers who have not yet come, the decision drivers are past experience, word-of-mouth and digital content: articles, social media and influencers [5]. The same survey found that 67% of those travelers have visited Santa Barbara at some point, against 63% for Sonoma and Napa Valley [5]. Santa Barbara's visitors, drawn from the same markets, probably decide in much the same way; the figures describe San Luis Obispo County's visitors, not Santa Barbara's.

A younger segment, solo travelers and Gen Z visitors drawn to destinations that blend adventure, wellness, and individual experiences, looks to be growing. In the SVB 2026 report [3], wineries investing in narrative and insider experiences report higher conversion, club acquisition and repeat visitation. We think the wineries offering seasonal events, food pairings, and behind-the-scenes access are the ones retaining and growing their club memberships.

How They Find You

Visitors reach a tasting room by three paths, and different signals matter on each.

The Pre-Planner. This person does most of their work before they leave home. They search Google for “best wineries in Santa Barbara” or “Los Olivos wine tasting weekend”, read travel blogs, and cross-reference TripAdvisor reviews. TripAdvisor is likely a starting point even when someone ultimately books elsewhere: they use it to compare, get a read on the vibe, and decide whether the experience fits a group or couple. Instagram probably validates the shortlist, and more of these visitors now plan with AI: MMGY Travel Intelligence’s summer 2026 Portrait of American Travelers, interviews with 4,371 U.S. adults in May 2026, found that 52% of active leisure travelers have used AI to help plan a trip, up 10 percentage points in a year, “with ChatGPT (57%) and Gemini (42%) emerging as the most widely used travel planning tools” [6]. These visitors often arrive with their stops already decided.

What matters: Content and credibility: travel blog coverage, strong review presence, and a feed that signals “this is what you’re walking into.” A winery not appearing on curated lists, or appearing with thin information, loses these visitors before the trip is booked.

The Hotel-Guided Visitor. The overnigher who arrives without a complete plan and relies on hotel concierge or tour operators to fill the itinerary. We think this is a significant channel in the valley, and likely the one most correlated with higher-spend profiles. Local drivers, concierges, and private tour operators can surface wineries visitors would not have found on their own. These gatekeepers build itineraries from personal relationships and firsthand experience, so we think they make the winery choice for some of these visitors.

What matters: Relationships. If the hotel concierges and tour operators in your area don’t have a reason to mention you, you are unlikely to be on this visitor’s itinerary.

The Spontaneous Visitor. Arrives in town, pulls out their phone, types “wine tasting Los Olivos” into Google Maps. This is where your Google Business Profile and your reviews do most of the work. These are often day-trippers or people who had wine country on the agenda but didn’t plan the specifics. In our own data, the number of Google reviews a winery has is the measure most closely tied to being found and named; the rating barely separates wineries once it clears a floor.

What matters: Google Maps presence and review volume. A visitor who has picked the region likely searches within it, so a winery missing from the map results for its own corridor misses the searches this visitor makes.

Once They’re In-Region

We think the wine trails and route maps the county’s wine and tourism groups publish work as default itineraries for visitors who want structure without hiring a guide. Being on a trail doesn’t guarantee traffic, but we think not being well-represented on one is a quiet loss. Word of mouth compounds in-trip: a visitor who has a great experience asks the tasting room staff where else to go, and in our experience those referrals bypass every digital channel.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

The Rankings

Who AI Recommends

In this sample, Pallonte Cellars was named in 636 of the 1,324 answers about Santa Barbara County, more than any other winery. The table lists the wineries named most often, each with the range a rerun would most likely land in.

Most AI-Visible Wineries

#	Winery	Named	Out of	Share	Likely range
1	Pallonte Cellars	636	1,324	48%	45% to 51%
2	Stavade Wine Co.	398	1,324	30%	28% to 33%
3	Nalveau Vineyards	308	1,324	23%	21% to 26%
4	Becane Wine Co.	289	1,324	22%	20% to 24%
5	Stelto Family Wines	281	1,324	21%	19% to 24%
6	Veldara Family Wines	269	1,324	20%	18% to 23%
7	Muntance Vineyards	265	1,324	20%	18% to 22%
8	Vimino Family Wines	252	1,324	19%	17% to 21%
9	Ilvarra Wine Co.	247	1,324	19%	17% to 21%
10	Oscalla Estate	240	1,324	18%	16% to 20%
11	Misance Estate	237	1,324	18%	16% to 20%
12	Nirdello Cellars	234	1,324	18%	16% to 20%
13	Broltory Cellars	229	1,324	17%	15% to 19%
14	Vildory Cellars	224	1,324	17%	15% to 19%
15	Trilva Family Wines	206	1,324	16%	14% to 18%

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Share is the fraction of the 1,324 answers about Santa Barbara County that named the winery. The likely range is where a rerun of the same questions would most likely land. Wineries named equally often are listed alphabetically.

The assistants differ in how many of the county’s wineries they name. For each one, the table gives how many answers it gave and how many different wineries those answers named.

Answers and Wineries Named, by AI Assistant

AI assistant	Answers	Wineries named
ChatGPT (search enabled)	225	134
Claude (web search)	225	140
Perplexity	225	133
Google AI Overviews	199	117
Microsoft Copilot	225	97
Gemini (current Flash, Google Search grounding)	225	129

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

What the Named Wineries Have in Common

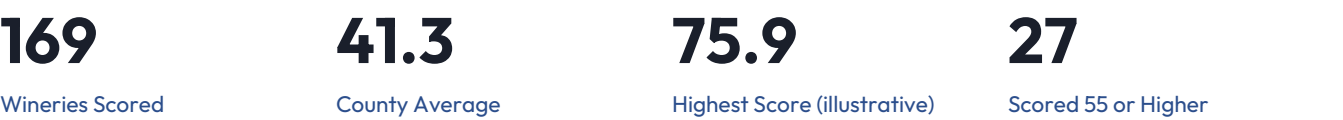
An AI assistant reads what the web says about you, not only what is on your own website. It synthesizes reviews, press, blog coverage, and directory listings into a named recommendation. In our own data, the wineries the assistants named score higher than the ones they passed over, and the gap is widest on Review Volume & Reputation: 8.2 of 25 points for the wineries named, against 2.1 for the rest (153 named, 16 not). That doesn't prove the gap causes the naming, but it's the strongest link in our data.

AI trip planning is already happening, and we expect it to grow. A winery missing from these answers today will likely find it harder to surface as more visitors plan this way.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

The Digital Readiness Score

The score comes second because it measures the signals our data ties to being named, not the result: seven categories, 100 points in all, scored the same way for every winery. The tiles give the county’s count, average and best score; the lines under them split the average into its two halves.



Discoverability: the county averages 20.8 of 69 points (30% of max).

Conversion: the county averages 20.5 of 31 points (66% of max).

Score Distribution

How the county’s 169 scores fall across our grade bands. A band is a label for where a score sits, not a second score.



Performance by Town

Visitors navigate by town, not by AVA: a couple planning an afternoon chooses a road, not an appellation. A couple driving up from LA is choosing between an afternoon in Los Olivos, a walk through Solvang, or a Lompoc Wine Ghetto crawl. The table shows each tasting hub with at least three wineries.

Town	Wineries	Avg Score	Top Score
Santa Ynez	10	52.4	74.1
Solvang	19	46.5	75.9
Los Olivos	38	45.2	72.9
Buellton	16	42.4	63.8
Santa Barbara	28	41.2	69.0
Santa Maria	10	38.2	64.3
Los Alamos	10	35.7	53.7
Lompoc	32	34.3	69.5

Wineries and Avg Score are as published. Top Score follows the invented wineries in this sample.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Top 10 Spotlight

These wineries lead Santa Barbara County in digital readiness. The marks after each line show the dimensions where a winery earns three quarters or more of the points (+) and where it earns less than half (↓). Arrows beside a name compare its rank with the Q2 2026 edition.

Columns: 3RD Third-Party Presence, REV Review Volume & Reputation, SCH Search & Map Discovery, BKG AI-Ready Booking & Buying, PRF Profile Accuracy, CIT Citation Readiness, SOC Social.

#1 Vicova Estate (Solvang) ↑17

Total: 75.9/100 3RD: 17.5/23 REV: 20.2/25 SCH: 11.1/21 BKG: 13.9/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5/6 SOC: 2.2/5
+ 3RD, REV, BKG, PRF, CIT ↓ SOC

#2 Pallonte Cellars (Santa Ynez) ↑2

Total: 74.1/100 3RD: 13.5/23 REV: 17.8/25 SCH: 15.5/21 BKG: 11.3/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 6/6 SOC: 4/5
+ BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC

#3 Ferdova Wine Co. (town not listed) ↑40

Total: 73.3/100 3RD: 13.2/23 REV: 15.1/25 SCH: 15.7/21 BKG: 13.6/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5.9/6 SOC: 3.8/5
+ BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC

#4 Toltello Estate (Los Olivos) ↑9

Total: 72.9/100 3RD: 11.4/23 REV: 18.9/25 SCH: 15.9/21 BKG: 11.2/14 PRF: 5.1/6 CIT: 5.4/6 SOC: 4.9/5
+ REV, SCH, BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC ↓ 3RD

#5 Nalveau Vineyards (Los Olivos) ↑13

Total: 72.8/100 3RD: 12.9/23 REV: 17.5/25 SCH: 12.5/21 BKG: 14/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5.9/6 SOC: 3.9/5
+ BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC

#6 Feltory Winery (Lompoc) ↑22

Total: 69.5/100 3RD: 12.4/23 REV: 14.3/25 SCH: 12.5/21 BKG: 13.9/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5.9/6 SOC: 4.5/5
+ BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC

#7 Gildette Vineyards (Santa Barbara) ↑63

Total: 69.0/100 3RD: 12.3/23 REV: 16.8/25 SCH: 10.1/21 BKG: 13.9/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5/6 SOC: 4.9/5
+ BKG, PRF, CIT, SOC ↓ SCH

#8 Galdane Winery (Los Olivos) ↑28

Total: 66.5/100 3RD: 9.7/23 REV: 12.4/25 SCH: 17.9/21 BKG: 11.3/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5.8/6 SOC: 3.4/5
+ SCH, BKG, PRF, CIT ↓ 3RD, REV

#9 Ilvarra Wine Co. (Santa Ynez) ↑3

Total: 64.8/100 3RD: 9.2/23 REV: 16.5/25 SCH: 11.7/21 BKG: 13.6/14 PRF: 5.8/6 CIT: 4.1/6 SOC: 3.9/5
+ BKG, PRF, SOC ↓ 3RD

#10 Purvade Cellars (Santa Maria) ↑12

Total: 64.3/100 3RD: 7.7/23 REV: 10.2/25 SCH: 19.5/21 BKG: 12.8/14 PRF: 6/6 CIT: 5/6 SOC: 2.9/5
+ SCH, BKG, PRF, CIT ↓ 3RD, REV

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. The full edition profiles the county's real top ten here.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Top 10: Third-Party Presence (23 pts)

What it measures: do the lists, guides, and press that visitors and AI assistants read name you? Who else says you are worth visiting.

#	Winery	Score	Town
1	Ombressa Estate	17.8/23	Los Alamos
2	Vicova Estate	17.5/23	Solvang
3	Nirdello Cellars	15.3/23	Buellton
4	Boreau Winery	15.1/23	Solvang
5	Funtello Vineyards	14.4/23	Lompoc
6	Veldara Family Wines	13.9/23	
7	Mirdena Winery	13.5/23	Santa Ynez
8	Pallonte Cellars	13.5/23	Santa Ynez
9	Muntance Vineyards	13.3/23	Lompoc
10	Ferdova Wine Co.	13.2/23	

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Scores are shared in this category: two of the ten wineries listed here scored 13.5. Wineries sharing a score are listed alphabetically, not ranked against each other, at the top of the table as much as at the cut.

Top 9: Review Volume & Reputation (25 pts)

What it measures: how many people vouch for you, and are they still doing it? The pre-planner’s starting point. Volume and recent reviews count; a high rating on a handful of reviews no longer carries the category.

#	Winery	Score	Town
1	Vicova Estate	20.2/25	Solvang
2	Toltello Estate	18.9/25	Los Olivos
3	Pallonte Cellars	17.8/25	Santa Ynez
4	Nalveau Vineyards	17.5/25	Los Olivos
5	Gildette Vineyards	16.8/25	Santa Barbara
6	Ilvarra Wine Co.	16.5/25	Santa Ynez
7	Marlessa Estate	15.9/25	Solvang
8	Iselva Winery	15.6/25	Solvang
9	Dorvana Vineyards	15.5/25	Santa Barbara

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Scores are shared in this category: the next score, 15.1, is shared by 2 of the 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County, more than the table has room for, so it stops at nine. Wineries sharing a score are listed alphabetically, not ranked against each other, at the top of the table as much as at the cut.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Top 10: Search & Map Discovery (21 pts)

What it measures: when a visitor searches for wineries rather than for you by name, do you come up, in the results and on the map? The searches a visitor types before they have your name.

#	Winery	Score	Town
1	Purvade Cellars	19.5/21	Santa Maria
2	Galdane Winery	17.9/21	Los Olivos
3	Toltello Estate	15.9/21	Los Olivos
4	Ferdova Wine Co.	15.7/21	
5	Pallonte Cellars	15.5/21	Santa Ynez
6	Indrena Vineyards	13.4/21	Lompoc
7	Muntance Vineyards	13.4/21	Lompoc
8	Veldara Family Wines	13.1/21	
9	Trebino Family Wines	12.7/21	Santa Maria
10	Cabance Wine Co.	12.6/21	Los Olivos

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Scores are shared in this category: two of the ten wineries listed here scored 13.4. Wineries sharing a score are listed alphabetically, not ranked against each other, at the top of the table as much as at the cut.

Top 8: AI-Ready Booking & Buying (14 pts)

What it measures: once someone has picked you, can they book, join, and buy without picking up the phone? Where an interested visitor either completes or leaks away.

#	Winery	Score	Town
1	Drontello Family Wines	14.0/14	Lompoc
2	Larkhollow Vineyards	14.0/14	Santa Maria
3	Nalveau Vineyards	14.0/14	Los Olivos
4	Quilvara Winery	14.0/14	Los Olivos
5	Stelto Family Wines	14.0/14	Solvang
6	Sundova Winery	14.0/14	Buellton
7	Tepeau Vineyards	14.0/14	Los Olivos
8	Veldara Family Wines	14.0/14	

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Scores are shared in this category: the next score, 13.9, is shared by 14 of the 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County, more than the table has room for, so it stops at eight. Wineries sharing a score are listed alphabetically, not ranked against each other, at the top of the table as much as at the cut.

Profile Accuracy (6 pts)

39 of 169 Santa Barbara wineries scored the full 6 points on Profile Accuracy. With that many sharing the top score, a table of the first ten alphabetically would rank nothing, so we print none.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Citation Readiness (6 pts)

11 of 169 Santa Barbara wineries scored the full 6 points on Citation Readiness. With that many sharing the top score, a table of the first ten alphabetically would rank nothing, so we print none.

Top 8: Social (5 pts)

What it measures: does your Instagram confirm you’re open, active, and worth visiting? Instagram is likely how many wine country visitors check their shortlist.

#	Winery	Score	Town
1	Fasette Family Wines	4.9/5	Los Olivos
2	Gildette Vineyards	4.9/5	Santa Barbara
3	Toltello Estate	4.9/5	Los Olivos
4	Elvarde Estate	4.8/5	Santa Barbara
5	Feltory Winery	4.5/5	Lompoc
6	Stodello Wine Co.	4.5/5	Los Olivos
7	Iselva Winery	4.4/5	Solvang
8	Zerenza Family Wines	4.4/5	Los Olivos

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. Scores are shared in this category: three of the eight wineries listed here scored 4.9 and the next score, 4.3, is shared by 4 of the 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County, more than the table has room for, so it stops at eight. Wineries sharing a score are listed alphabetically, not ranked against each other, at the top of the table as much as at the cut.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Can AI Read Your Store?

Who AI Recommends asked whether AI assistants name you. This section asks something more basic: when an AI assistant tries to read your store, does anything come back? When a shopper asks ChatGPT, Perplexity, or Claude “where can I buy this wine,” the answer engine’s crawler usually fetches your page the way a simple reader does: one request, no JavaScript, no waiting out a security check. We read every winery’s store exactly that way.

54 of 169 wineries returned a store a basic AI crawler can read, prices included. 92 came back walled off, empty without JavaScript, or without prices.

Status	Wineries	Share	What it means
Readable	54	32%	Products and prices are in the page HTML. Crawlers and AI readers see your wines.
Prices hidden	68	40%	Products are readable without JavaScript, but the prices are not.
Gated	20	12%	The store builds its catalog with JavaScript. A crawler that does not run scripts gets an empty shell.
Walled	4	2%	The store page turns automated readers away instead of serving the catalog.
Dated store	2	1%	Wine can be ordered online, but through a dated process with no browsable catalog.
No store	9	5%	No online store was found on the site.
Not measured	12	7%	We could not complete the read this month; this is our gap, not a finding about the winery.

Your site can look flawless in a browser and still be invisible here, because people run JavaScript and wait out security checks, while the fast-growing answer engines usually do neither.

Part of this is in the score: whether the store and club pages, prices included, read without JavaScript sits inside Citation Readiness. Whether a store page turns crawlers away is reported here and is not scored on its own.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Complete County Rankings

All 169 wineries we scored this quarter in Santa Barbara County, ranked by total digital readiness score. Wineries sharing a score share a rank and are listed alphabetically.

Columns: 3RD Third-Party Presence, REV Review Volume & Reputation, SCH Search & Map Discovery, BKG AI-Ready Booking & Buying, PRF Profile Accuracy, CIT Citation Readiness, SOC Social. Marks: * limited review coverage; § website could not be read; the notes under the table explain each.

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
1	↑17	Vicova Estate	Svang	17.5	20.2	11.1	13.9	6	5	2.2	75.9
2	↑2	Pallonte Cellars	Santa Ynez	13.5	17.8	15.5	11.3	6	6	4	74.1
3	↑40	Ferdova Wine Co.		13.2	15.1	15.7	13.6	6	5.9	3.8	73.3
4	↑9	Toltello Estate	Los Olivos	11.4	18.9	15.9	11.2	5.1	5.4	4.9	72.9
5	↑13	Nalveau Vineyards	Los Olivos	12.9	17.5	12.5	14	6	5.9	3.9	72.8
6	↑22	Feltory Winery	Lompoc	12.4	14.3	12.5	13.9	6	5.9	4.5	69.5
7	↑63	Gildette Vineyards	Santa Barbara	12.3	16.8	10.1	13.9	6	5	4.9	69.0
8	↑28	Galdane Winery	Los Olivos	9.7	12.4	17.9	11.3	6	5.8	3.4	66.5
9	↑3	Ilvarra Wine Co.	Santa Ynez	9.2	16.5	11.7	13.6	5.8	4.1	3.9	64.8
10	↑12	Purvade Cellars	Santa Maria	7.7	10.2	19.5	12.8	6	5	2.9	64.3
11	↑43	Broltory Cellars	Buellton	12.9	12.8	11.5	12.8	5.2	4.4	4.2	63.8
12	↑12	Muntance Vineyards	Lompoc	13.3	9.9	13.4	12.7	6	4.6	3.5	63.5
12	↓6	Veldara Family Wines		13.9	11.3	13.1	14	4.1	4.1	3	63.5
14	↑5	Zerenza Family Wines	Los Olivos	12.7	13.7	7.6	13.1	6	5.5	4.4	63.0
15	↑14	Marlessa Estate	Svang	11.2	15.9	10.7	12.5	6	4.9	1.4	62.5
16	↑16	Stelto Family Wines	Svang	11.9	14.1	9.1	14	4.1	5.3	3.7	62.1
17	↑6	Vildory Cellars	Los Olivos	13	12.9	10	12	5.9	3.9	4.1	61.8
18	↓9	Boreau Winery	Svang	15.1	13.3	8.5	11.8	5	3.3	3.1	60.0
19	↓8	Dorvana Vineyards	Santa Barbara	8.4	15.5	8.1	13.9	4.6	5	4.1	59.7
20	↑16	Misance Estate	Los Olivos	11.2	12.4	7.3	13.9	5.9	4.2	3.7	58.6
21	↓8	Nagova Estate	Santa Maria	11.6	12.7	8.5	11.5	6	5.2	2.9	58.4
22	↓3	Tepeau Vineyards	Los Olivos	9.1	13.5	9.1	14	4.9	3.6	3.9	58.0
23	↓15	Nirdello Cellars	Buellton	15.3	10.5	7.8	7.8	6	6	4.2	57.6
24	↓21	Rilona Wine Co.	Svang	10.1	12.7	7.1	12.4	6	4.7	3.7	56.8
25	↓11	Vimino Family Wines	Santa Barbara	11.4	12.8	8.9	11.1	2.5	6	3	55.6

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
26	↑29	Sulvette Estate	Santa Barbara	9.8	13.4	7.9	11.2	6	3.1	3.9	55.4
27	↓2	Becane Wine Co.	Santa Ynez	10	14.8	10.9	7.8	6	3	2.5	55.0
28	↑61	Taltova Family Wines	Solvang	8.9	13	8.2	11.8	5.9	3.8	2.6	54.3
29	↓15	Cabance Wine Co.	Los Olivos	8	7.4	12.6	11.4	5.1	6	3.6	54.1
29	↑61	Marrowby Estate	Los Olivos	8.4	13.2	8.5	10	3.9	5.9	4.3	54.1
31	↑10	Trilva Family Wines	Lompoc	10.7	10.6	9.4	11.3	5.6	2.9	3.4	53.8
32	↑2	Goldino Vineyards	Los Alamos	6.9	8.4	9.9	13.9	6	6	2.6	53.7
32	↓19	Stegona Wine Co.	Los Olivos	12.9	7.8	5.4	13.9	5	4.9	3.8	53.7
34	↓22	Oscalla Estate	Lompoc	8.1	9.3	7.7	12.4	6	5.9	4.2	53.5
35	↓12	Dantory Family Wines	Buellton	7.4	12.3	4.8	13.9	6	4.8	3.7	52.9
35	↑1	Guvane Vineyards	Santa Barbara	11.7	8.2	7.3	11.8	5.3	4.6	4	52.9
37	↑30	Stavade Wine Co.	Buellton	7.7	13.2	7.5	9.7	4.9	5.9	3.1	52.0
38	=	Stesette Vineyards	Santa Barbara	8.7	10.4	9.5	10.4	6	2.9	3.6	51.5
39	↓4	Cindona Cellars	Santa Barbara	9.8	8.1	9	11.6	6	4.3	2.4	51.2
40	↓1	Tiltara Family Wines	Santa Barbara	6.1	13.7	7.4	10	6	6	1.8	50.9
41	↑5	Gupette Estate	Solvang	9.5	10	5.8	10.8	5.9	4.4	4.3	50.8
42	↑5	Fasette Family Wines	Los Olivos	6.3	4.9	10.3	13.9	6	4.3	4.9	50.5
43	↓13	Iselva Winery	Solvang	10.9	15.6	4.9	4.7	6	3.7	4.4	50.2
43	↑55	Ombressa Estate	Los Alamos	17.8	10.8	5.7	4.7	4.9	2.5	3.8	50.2
45	↑36	Mirdena Winery	Santa Ynez	13.5	8.3	5.5	8.4	6	4.9	3.5	50.0
46	↓39	Quilvara Winery	Los Olivos	9.6	7.4	8.8	14	5.4	4.5	0	49.8
47	↑45	Wrenvale Wine Co.	Lompoc	10.6	7	11.2	7.4	4.4	5.4	3.1	49.1
48	↑23	Trebino Family Wines	Santa Maria	4.1	6.4	12.7	10.7	5.8	5.9	3.2	48.8
49	↓13	Indrena Vineyards	Lompoc	7	7.4	13.4	5.7	5.9	5.4	3.9	48.7
50	↓11	Brimova Cellars	Solvang	11.3	5.2	6.3	13.9	5.8	4.5	1.6	48.5
51	NEW	Stulvara Family Wines	Buellton	5.5	13.3	7	7.2	5.4	5.9	4	48.3
51	↑27	Stuneau Vineyards	Los Olivos	6.8	6.7	6.2	13.4	6	5.5	3.7	48.3
53	↓33	Ducory Winery	Lompoc	11	10.5	7.3	8.5	5.1	4.4	1	47.8
53	↓8	Lervino Winery	Santa Ynez	9.5	2.7	8.7	13	5.9	4.4	3.6	47.8

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
55	↑36	Belteau Family Wines	Buellton	8.8	12.7	5.6	9.1	3.6	4.1	3.6	47.4
56	↓21	Drebette Vineyards	Santa Ynez	12.4	7.5	6.5	9	4.2	6	1.5	47.0
57	NEW	Funtello Vineyards	Lompoc	14.4	9.1	5.6	8.4	2.5	3.3	3.6	46.8
57	↓19	Gepova Family Wines	Los Olivos	7	10	4	13.5	6	2.9	3.3	46.8
57	↓35	Lurvena Estate	Los Olivos	7.1	7.8	5.2	11.7	6	5.7	3.5	46.8
60	↓6	Gerveau Wine Co.	Los Olivos	10.5	11.3	5.5	8.1	4	3.7	3.4	46.6
61	↑9	Dulvello Wine Co.		8.6	6	7.3	9.7	6	6	2.9	46.5
62	↑4	Bruldova Vineyards	Santa Barbara	5.4	9.3	6	13	3.3	5.9	3.4	46.2
62	↑71	Neldena Wine Co.	Solvang	9.6	7.5	6.5	8.7	5.4	4.4	4.1	46.2
64	↓28	Tragette Cellars	Solvang	10	7.9	10	5.7	6	2.7	3.8	46.1
65	↓45	Pentade Vineyards	Solvang	7.2	13.8	6.3	8.9	4.1	5.2	0	45.6
66	NEW	Brabeau Wine Co.	Santa Ynez	10.9	7.8	5.6	11.4	3.7	6	0	45.4
67	↓7	Senara Vineyards	Los Olivos	7.9	6.4	7.8	9.2	5.3	4.2	4.3	45.1
68	=	Brosara Vineyards	Los Olivos	8.6	8.7	3.8	9.9	6	4.4	3.5	44.9
69	↑29	Stibara Winery	Los Olivos	11	12.2	4.6	7.7	4.8	3.9	0.7	44.8
70	↑5	Brusette Winery	Lompoc	5.3	10.2	9.6	10.8	3.4	3.6	1.4	44.4
70	↓30	Pameau Winery	Santa Ynez	4.8	15.1	5.9	9.4	4.6	3.5	1.1	44.4
72	↑22	Brogade Winery	Lompoc	4	12.8	5.2	8.9	5.7	4.5	3.1	44.3
73	↑8	Forvine Estate	Santa Barbara	8.7	12.5	4.5	6.8	5.2	5.4	1	44.2
74	↓34	Drantade Vineyards	Santa Barbara	5.3	6.8	7.5	11.4	6	3.8	3.3	44.1
75	↓8	Cultade Cellars	Los Olivos	6.1	10.3	5.6	10.8	4.1	4	3	44.0
76	↑1	Cubeau Wine Co.	Los Olivos	10.9	8.5	4.4	8.4	5.5	4.6	1.6	43.9
76	↓39	Multena Winery	Santa Barbara	10.6	5.9	4.6	9.3	4.5	5.7	3.3	43.9
76	↑17	Vusello Vineyards	Santa Ynez	5.4	9.4	6.8	12.7	4.5	4.8	0.3	43.9
79	↑10	Lendette Family Wines	Santa Barbara	7.7	7.3	5.9	10.1	4.6	6	2.1	43.8
80	↓12	Drontello Family Wines	Lompoc	5.4	9	4.4	14	4.8	4.7	1.3	43.6
80	↓17	Stogory Wine Co.	Buellton	9.7	8.5	5.4	7.1	6	4.2	2.7	43.6
82	↑20	Barvona Vineyards	Buellton	11.7	7.9	6	8.2	2	4.7	3	43.5
83	↑3	Pacello Winery	Los Olivos	7.3	11.1	6.5	7.7	6	4.3	0	42.9
84	↑24	Larkhollow Vineyards	Santa Maria	6.3	7.5	5.2	14	3.6	3.9	2.3	42.7

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
85	↑3	Murvory Family Wines	Santa Barbara	8.3	9.6	3.9	8.2	4.5	5.4	2.6	42.6
86	↑25	Burvance Wine Co.	Los Alamos	4.2	6.4	6.1	12.3	5.2	5.2	3	42.4
87	↑10	Sundova Winery	Buellton	7.7	5.6	6.8	14	3	2.7	2.4	42.3
88	↓19	Fanade Vineyards	Buellton	5.3	9.5	8	9.9	3.7	2.6	3.1	42.2
88	↓11	Stacova Vineyards	Los Olivos	7	7.6	4.2	7.6	6	5.8	3.9	42.2
90	↑38	Pontena Winery	Los Alamos	8.1	8.6	5.6	8.5	6	3.8	1.5	42.1
91	↓18	Elvarde Estate	Santa Barbara	4	8.8	4.3	8.1	5.7	5	4.8	40.9
92	NEW	Vonteau Cellars	Santa Maria	5.5	5.4	9.5	9.6	3.1	5.7	1.7	40.5
93	↑20	Driseau Cellars	Santa Barbara	7.5	10.2	2.9	8.6	4.5	3.7	2.4	39.9
94	↓12	Londara Cellars *	Santa Barbara	4.3	1	10.3	12.6	5.5	5.2	0.7	39.7
95	NEW	Nopory Family Wines	Solvang	6	11.5	6.8	4.1	3.4	3.7	3.6	39.2
96	NEW	Jastena Winery		4.7	4.4	6.5	13.9	3.6	4	1.9	39.1
97	↓1	Mesona Cellars	Los Alamos	6.2	7.6	3.9	8.2	5.9	4.9	1.2	38.0
97	↑31	Timette Cellars	Los Olivos	2.7	7.6	4.5	11.3	4.8	3	4.2	38.0
99	↑44	Fandena Winery	Los Olivos	2.3	3.9	5.3	13.4	4.2	5.3	3.5	37.9
100	↓10	Filvena Winery	Los Olivos	2.9	6.2	4.8	9.1	4.9	5.9	4	37.8
101	↓2	Dagena Family Wines	Buellton	8.6	6.1	7.2	5.5	4.4	5.9	0	37.6
102	NEW	Nolvance Winery	Los Olivos	5.5	8	6.9	5.3	5.5	4.6	1.7	37.5
103	↓18	Mivade Estate		0	2.9	6.7	13.9	4	5.5	4.2	37.3
103	↓41	Trudane Cellars *	Los Olivos	5.3	2.6	4.2	13.3	5.2	3.9	2.7	37.3
105	↓13	Kelvane Estate	Los Olivos	4.9	8.4	4.5	4.3	5.9	5.9	3.3	37.1
105	↑46	Merrisa Family Wines	Los Olivos	4.6	5.1	6.2	5.8	5.5	5.5	4.3	37.1
107	↓20	Driltino Vineyards *	Los Alamos	7.7	0	4.5	12.7	5.9	5.9	0	36.7
108	↑16	Vuldeau Vineyards	Santa Barbara	2.5	7	2.3	13.9	5.9	3.4	1.5	36.4
109	↓1	Boldona Wine Co.	Lompoc	2.2	6	6.4	9.6	5.8	3.7	2.6	36.3
110	↑2	Sevance Wine Co.	Los Alamos	6.7	5.2	5.4	11.9	3.2	2.8	1.1	36.2
111	↓31	Vurdane Winery	Solvang	3.6	4.9	3.5	13.9	5	5.1	0	36.0
112	↓93	Pelette Vineyards	Lompoc	5.5	8.5	6.7	3.5	4.7	3.7	2.9	35.6
113	↑17	Ostrano Cellars	Solvang	4.3	7	4.2	9.4	4.9	4.6	0.7	35.0
113	↓35	Socona Cellars	Santa Barbara	5.5	7	4.8	6.2	5.5	5.4	0.7	35.0

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
115	↑7	Hollanza Estate	Buellton	4.4	4.5	5.3	8.9	4.8	5.9	1.2	34.9
116	↓22	Garvello Cellars	Santa Barbara	5.5	5.6	5.4	9.1	4	3.1	2	34.8
117	↑42	Bredory Winery	Los Olivos	5.2	8.5	4.4	8.1	4.3	3.3	0.8	34.7
118	↑10	Legory Cellars	Lompoc	5.8	3	5.2	5.5	5.4	5.3	3.3	33.4
119	↑39	Drasane Family Wines	Santa Barbara	2	4.5	4	10.8	3.9	5.3	2.7	33.1
119	NEW	Quessara Winery	Lompoc	7	5.9	4.8	3.9	4.7	4	2.7	33.1
119	↑8	Tibena Estate	Solvang	5.1	7.6	4.1	7.2	3.9	2.8	2.3	33.1
122	↑7	Braddello Family Wines	Solvang	4.6	5.6	4.1	6.1	6	3.5	2.5	32.4
123	↑19	Trovory Family Wines	Los Olivos	1.3	3.1	5.6	8.6	5.6	4.6	3.5	32.3
124	↑26	Calvessa Family Wines *	Lompoc	8.4	2.7	3.8	7.5	3.2	4.8	1.4	31.8
125	↓14	Ridara Estate	Santa Barbara	5.7	4.5	4.2	8.2	2.5	3.4	2.7	31.2
126	↓4	Brudena Cellars	Los Olivos	8.1	3.7	3.9	6.2	3.7	3.1	2.3	31.1
126	↓41	Rhovena Wine Co.	Solvang	1.8	2.3	5.3	10	6	2.7	3.1	31.1
128	↓35	Lonova Cellars	Los Olivos	6.8	5.5	8.5	2.7	5.5	0.6	1.2	30.8
129	↑11	Orvessa Winery	Santa Maria	3.3	7	5.9	7.7	3.7	2.3	0	30.0
130	↑12	Brugello Estate	Santa Ynez	5.9	3.9	4.8	6.4	2.9	3.5	2.5	29.9
131	↓23	Nevora Family Wines	Los Alamos	4.1	2.7	2	8	5.5	3.1	3.3	28.8
131	↑1	Tralvance Vineyards	Buellton	2	3.8	3.9	7.7	5.4	3.4	2.6	28.8
133	↑7	Tradova Wine Co.	Lompoc	4	4.8	4.5	5.2	4.7	4.3	1	28.5
134	↓6	Bulvine Estate	Los Olivos	0	8.8	2.3	8.1	6	2.3	0.8	28.3
134	↓13	Lomena Vineyards	Santa Barbara	5.8	2.5	4.7	8.4	4.3	1.7	0.9	28.3
136	↓14	Dribory Wine Co.	Buellton	7.4	5.4	1.4	0	5.9	5.9	2.1	28.2
137	NEW	Bentova Cellars	Lompoc	3.9	4	3.8	5.5	3.4	4.8	2.7	28.1
138	↓17	Kelmorra Vineyards	Santa Barbara	2.5	4.3	4	9.1	4.2	2.7	1	27.8
139	↑3	Dirdino Cellars	Lompoc	6.1	3.8	3.5	3.9	5.5	4.5	0.3	27.6
140	↓1	Dellora Winery §	Lompoc	5.5	5.2	3.3	8.6	2	2.4	0	27.1
141	NEW	Drulvory Family Wines		3.1	5	3.1	7.1	3.7	2.9	1.9	26.8
142	NEW	Jorvelle Wine Co.	Santa Maria	2	4.6	6.8	6.6	0	3.5	2.6	26.1
143	↓28	Ostenza Cellars	Solvang	4.7	0.8	3	8.9	3.1	2.8	2.5	25.9

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

#	CHG RANK	Winery	Town	3RD /23	REV /25	SCH /21	BKG /14	PRF /6	CIT /6	SOC /5	TOTAL /100
144	↓29	Valtance Family Wines	Los Olivos	7.3	4.9	3.5	1.6	2.6	4.8	0.7	25.5
145	NEW	Novette Wine Co. *	Lompoc	7.4	2.1	3.7	3.3	2	3.6	3	25.1
146	↓20	Nupena Wine Co.	Lompoc	5.7	6.1	1	2.3	5.3	3.3	1	24.6
147	NEW	Evandre Wine Co.	Buellton	2.7	4	2.5	6.2	3.1	2.8	2.9	24.1
148	NEW	Tamberre Estate	Lompoc	7.3	1.7	2.4	6.4	2.4	2.5	0.8	23.5
149	↓11	Varvette Family Wines *	Lompoc	6	1.1	3.6	4.6	2.3	3.8	2	23.2
150	↓43	Trelde Cellars	Lompoc	0	2.3	3.9	5.4	5.9	4.8	0.8	23.1
151	↓10	Telvesse Cellars	Los Alamos	3.1	0	4.4	8.2	0	5.9	1.2	22.7
152	↓39	Wyndora Wine Co.	Lompoc	10	0	3.9	0	2.4	2.5	3.6	22.5
153	↓64	Trunara Wine Co.	Santa Barbara	5.6	4	3.6	3.4	0	5.5	0.4	22.4
154	↓3	Siceau Winery	Lompoc	6.8	2.2	1.9	2.4	2.3	3.5	2.8	21.9
155	↓29	Stodello Wine Co.	Los Olivos	0	0	4.7	6.3	2.9	3.2	4.5	21.6
156	↓8	Drapara Wine Co.	Santa Barbara	3.7	2.1	2	9.2	0	4.2	0	21.4
156	↓24	Stintova Vineyards	Santa Maria	4.7	0	3.9	7.8	4	0.6	0.4	21.4
158	↑11	Zantera Cellars	Lompoc	0	1.9	2.2	6.3	3.4	4.6	2.5	21.1
159	↓2	Nebade Cellars *	Lompoc	0	0	3.6	4.9	4.6	5.9	2	21.0
160	↑6	Sorvanne Estate	Lompoc	4.7	0.7	2	3.9	4	4.5	0.8	20.6
161	↓54	Derdory Family Wines	Lompoc	5.9	0	4.1	4.3	2	2.8	0.7	19.9
162	↓4	Gumona Wine Co.	Buellton	1.4	4.6	2.1	2	3.1	2.9	3.1	19.1
163	↓7	Aurelda Family Wines	Lompoc	1.7	0	1.6	5.2	1.6	4.2	2.9	17.2
164	↑1	Vorade Estate	Santa Barbara	7.6	1	1.8	0	2.1	3.8	0	16.3
165	↓35	Lopello Vineyards	Santa Maria	2.6	0.8	1.6	4.8	2.3	3.5	0.7	16.2
166	↓4	Drolena Cellars §	Los Olivos	3.5	0.4	1.5	3.3	1.2	2.1	1.8	14.1
167	↑1	Drelance Wine Co.	Los Alamos	3.2	0.7	0.4	2.1	0.8	6	0.3	13.6
168	↓22	Rondory Wine Co. *	Santa Barbara	0.7	0.6	2.9	3.2	3.4	2.2	0.5	13.4
169	↓17	Halvora Winery	Santa Maria	1.4	1	1.3	3.4	1	1.7	1.2	11.0

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. * Limited review coverage: we could not read a Google rating or a Yelp review count for this winery this period. Those two measures count as not earned, which lowers its review points, total and rank; that part of a low score is a gap in what we could read, not a finding. Its Google review count we did read. § Our crawler could not read this winery's website: the site answered with a bot-protection challenge, and most of its website measures count as not earned. We report the wall as a finding: a site that challenges automated readers may also turn away some of the AI search assistants that would read it. A winery can check whether its protection lets verified AI crawlers through. Category columns show points earned out of each category's maximum. TOTAL is scored

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

out of 100 over the checks that apply to each winery, so the columns need not add to it. CHG RANK shows each winery’s change in position against the Q2 2026 edition, counted among the wineries in both editions, so a winery entering or leaving the census moves nobody. NEW marks a winery that was not in that edition. The Q2 2026 edition was scored under an earlier rubric with six dimensions, so its points are not on this scale and no change in points is shown. A change in position mixes real change with the change in what we measure. Read the direction of a move against its neighbors; treat large single-quarter swings as directional, not precise.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Peer Groups

Wineries run different businesses. A tasting room out among the vines is not trying to win the same visitor as a room on a town square or a city street, so a county ranking is not the only comparison worth making. These tables rank each winery against wineries in the same kind of setting. The score is the same score; only the comparison changes.

Estate and vineyard tasting rooms

#	Winery	Town	Score	County rank
1	Vicova Estate	Solvang	75.9	1
2	Toltello Estate	Los Olivos	72.9	4
3	Ilvarra Wine Co.	Santa Ynez	64.8	9
4	Purvade Cellars	Santa Maria	64.3	10
5	Vildory Cellars	Los Olivos	61.8	17

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. 52 wineries in this group. The county rank is the winery’s place among all 169.

Town tasting rooms

#	Winery	Town	Score	County rank
1	Pallonte Cellars	Santa Ynez	74.1	2
2	Ferdova Wine Co.		73.3	3
3	Feltory Winery	Lompoc	69.5	6
4	Gildette Vineyards	Santa Barbara	69.0	7
5	Muntance Vineyards	Lompoc	63.5	12

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. 51 wineries in this group. The county rank is the winery’s place among all 169.

Urban tasting rooms (town-center wine districts)

#	Winery	Town	Score	County rank
1	Nalveau Vineyards	Los Olivos	72.8	5
2	Galdane Winery	Los Olivos	66.5	8
3	Broltory Cellars	Buellton	63.8	11
4	Veldara Family Wines		63.5	12
5	Boreau Winery	Solvang	60.0	18

Illustrative: invented wineries and figures, for this sample. 33 wineries in this group. The county rank is the winery’s place among all 169.

What to Do First

Two things to start with. The gaps we counted follow.

1. Run the two-minute check

Ask ChatGPT or Gemini where to taste in your own valley, look for your name in the answer, and note who is named in your place.

2. Make it easy for a visitor, and an assistant, to say yes to you

Wineries that score higher on reviews are named more often. The wineries the assistants named average 8.2 of 25 points on Review Volume & Reputation, against 2.1 for the rest (153 named, 16 not). They also score higher on what a visitor needs to book and buy: 9.3 of 14 points on AI-Ready Booking & Buying, against 5.5. Neither figure proves cause: they are links in our data, and the review gap is the largest in points of any category.

The Gaps We Counted

The county's average score and its weakest category, then whether AI names a winery at all and the gaps we counted in the categories that take sustained work. A gap counts only where we looked and found nothing; a winery we could not measure is never counted as having it.

The average winery scores 41.3/100, mid-pack territory. The best score in this sample is 75.9. In the complete rankings, the first three category columns are Discoverability and the last four Conversion, so you can see where your own points went.

Search & Map Discovery averages 6.2/21 (30% of max), level with Review Volume & Reputation as the county's weakest category. This category measures whether a winery comes up when a visitor searches for wineries rather than for it by name, on the map or in the results. That is the search a first-time visitor makes.

Not named by any AI assistant we asked. 16 of 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County have this gap.

We asked six AI assistants 75 trip-planning prompts and tracked which wineries each one named. A winery with strong search rankings can still be absent here, and vice versa: this channel runs on different signals.

Minimal or no Google review presence. 28 of 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County have this gap.

For the spontaneous visitor typing "wine tasting Los Olivos" into Google Maps, review volume is what our data ties most closely to being found and named.

Not named on any best-of list we read. 11 of 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County have this gap.

These are the "best wineries in" pages that rank in Google's top results for the searches visitors type, and they are among the pages AI answers draw on. A winery missing from every one of them is missing from the shortlist before the visitor opens a map.

No press or travel writing on the first page of its own name search. 119 of 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County have this gap.

When someone looks you up by name, the first page shows only your own pages and listings. Independent coverage is what tells a visitor, and an AI assistant, that someone else thinks you are worth the drive.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Absent from the Google Maps results for discovery searches. 82 of 169 wineries in Santa Barbara County have this gap.

A visitor searching the map for wineries, not for you by name, never sees you. That is the search the spontaneous visitor makes from the car.

The quicker fixes, the ones on your own website, are what Monitor checks for your winery every month and puts in order.

Where the Points Are: Categories by Effort

Not every point takes the same effort to earn. This is how the seven categories sort. Which of them your winery is missing, and in what order to fix them, is what Monitor tells you.

Fix Once: Profile Accuracy (6 pts).

Build Once: Citation Readiness (6 pts).

Set Up Once: AI-Ready Booking & Buying (14 pts).

Ongoing, Simple: Social (5 pts).

Ongoing, Requires Patience: Review Volume & Reputation (25 pts).

Strategic: Search & Map Discovery (21 pts).

Most Strategic: Third-Party Presence (23 pts).

What This Score Means For Your Winery

31% of the points in this rubric are things you can do yourself. AI-Ready Booking & Buying, Profile Accuracy, Citation Readiness and Social are yours to fix: most of it once, and Social a few minutes a week. These are attention-to-detail items, not strategy items.

The rest takes sustained work. Third-Party Presence, Review Volume & Reputation and Search & Map Discovery require sustained strategy, not a weekend project. Building a review profile that earns trust from pre-planners, earning a place on the lists and in the press that AI answers draw on, and appearing in the answers visitors plan from are operational challenges that compound over time. They are likely where the county's leaders pull furthest ahead.

Our Calls for Next Quarter

Each call below rests on a figure we measure ourselves. The Q4 2026 edition opens Our Calls, Scored by scoring each one Right, Wrong or Too early, with what else moved the count.

Call 1. Fewer Santa Barbara County wineries are named in AI answers: no more than 87% of the wineries we measure there will be named at least once across our three rounds of AI questions. Today it is 91%, 153 of the 169 wineries we measure today.

Why we think so: On the twelve questions we asked in both quarters, 22 Santa Barbara wineries were named in clearly fewer answers than in Q2 and 8 in clearly more, most of the fall coming from the two assistants that search the web. We think the same slide shows up across all our questions: a fall of six or more wineries, a bigger change than we see between our own three rounds of asking.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Call 2. Fewer Santa Barbara wineries show no tasting fee on any tasting or visit page of their own site: no more than 82 of the wineries whose site we can check, against 95 of the 159 we could check today.

Why we think so: It is a few minutes of work and this report puts it in front of every owner in the county. We think at least 13 of them make the change, more than the 10 sites we could not read, so a change in which sites we can read cannot settle the call on its own.

How to read this call: the 95 is counted only among the 159 wineries whose own site we could read and check for a fee this quarter. The other 10 could not be read and count neither way. If we can read more sites next quarter, the count can rise for that reason alone, and we will say so when we score the call.

How We Measure

How we measure AI visibility

We put 75 trip-planning prompts about Santa Barbara County to six AI surfaces with web search on, as a visitor sees them (ChatGPT (search enabled), Claude (web search), Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Microsoft Copilot and Gemini (current Flash, Google Search grounding)), three times over the month, for 1,324 answers in all. The prompts include several wordings of each question, because a visitor never types the question the same way twice. The result is an outcome, reported here on its own; it is not an input to anyone's score.

Google AI Overviews gave 199 answers, not 225: on 20 of the searches Google showed no AI Overview at all, which we record as a measured absence, and 6 more showed one we could not read in full, so those count neither way.

We ask six AI assistants rather than one, and that is deliberate. They do not return the same answer. A winery that comes up readily in one can be entirely absent from another, so any single assistant would give you a flattering or a punishing read depending on which one we happened to pick.

These answers are not fixed. Ask an AI assistant the same question twice in the same week and the list of wineries it names will shift. A winery at the edge of visibility moves in and out of the results without anything about the winery changing at all. So treat a single appearance as encouraging rather than settled: the goal is not to appear in one answer, it is to be the winery an AI assistant cannot construct a sensible answer without.

How we compare quarters. The comparisons in What Moved use the panel we kept unchanged from Q2 2026: the same 12 questions per county, put to the same four assistants. This quarter we asked them three times; Q2 2026 asked once, so we show each run and call a change real only when it is at least as large as the spread between our own runs. We also re-read Q2 2026's stored answers with this quarter's matcher, the routine that finds winery names in an answer, so both quarters are counted the same way. That is why a Q2 2026 count here can differ from the one that edition printed.

On that panel, 95 of the 155 wineries in both editions were named in Q2 2026, and this quarter our three rounds of asking named between 94 and 98 of the 155. These counts run lower than the 153 of 169 in The One Thing That Mattered This Quarter for two reasons. The panel is smaller: 12 questions to four assistants, against 75 prompts to six on the full panel. And the counting rule differs: The One Thing That Mattered This Quarter counts a winery named in any of the three rounds, while these figures count each run on its own. Counted over all 169 wineries we measure, one run of those 12 questions named 97 to 100, and the three runs together named 113.

If you hold last quarter's edition: it said 100 of 171 wineries were named by at least one AI assistant. That figure counted every winery in last quarter's census, including some that have since closed or left it, named in answer to any question about either county. The comparisons in this edition use only the wineries in both censuses, on their own county's questions.

The Rubric and How to Use It

“You should improve your digital presence” is not advice anyone can act on. This rubric shows where the points are. Its seven categories are built around the signals our own October test tied to being named by AI assistants and found by visitors. We deliberately did not score winemaking quality, critical acclaim, vineyard acreage, or tasting room aesthetics, because those are not what a first-time visitor can see before choosing. Every category measures something a winery can work on, though some, like the lists and press that name you, move slowly.

Every data point comes from publicly accessible sources, the same places your visitors look. No surveys. No self-reporting. No access to your private analytics. We read reviews, map and review listings, regional directories, search and map results, the best-of lists and travel press that rank for the searches visitors type, Instagram, and your own website. Separately, we put 75 trip-planning prompts to six AI assistants and track which wineries they name. That AI result is reported on its own and is not part of the score.

Two notes on method, because a number you cannot interrogate is not worth much. First, this edition is scored under rubric version v3.1, and every winery is measured at one location: several brands run more than one tasting room, and a score describes the room we measured, not every room. Second, this edition and the Q2 2026 edition were scored under different rubrics, so their points are not on one scale and we never subtract one from the other. What we compare across editions is position among the wineries in both; see the note under the rankings.

Your score reflects what a visitor actually encounters when searching for, evaluating, or trying to buy from you online. A high score means visitors can find you, your reviews inspire confidence, your site gives a visitor who is ready to book what they need, and your wine is easy to buy. A low score marks gaps we measured, and we think they are costing visits and DTC revenue over time; where a winery is marked * or § in the rankings, part of its low score is a gap in what we could read, not a finding. The encouraging part: 31% of the points in this rubric are things you can fix yourself, most of them in a few focused days. The rest take sustained strategy and patience, but they compound.

Why the Ruler Moved

Last quarter's edition scored six dimensions. This one scores seven categories. We changed the ruler to score the measures our data ties to being named, and each change follows with the reason for it. The change is a finding in its own right, not an excuse. Points on the two rubrics are not on one scale, so the comparisons in this edition are by position, never by points.

Third-Party Presence is a new category: named on the best-of lists that rank for visitors' discovery searches, regional tourism and trade directories, and editorial and travel press. The answers in our own AI panel cite third-party pages, TripAdvisor, regional guides and travel lists most of all, and the previous rubric had no measure for being named by them.

August 12, 2026: Google's AI Overviews in local results quote listicles as their main source. (SE Roundtable)

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Review volume weighs more and ratings less: the review-count ladders run much higher, a 90-day review count is new, and five rating measures became one rating floor. In our October driver test, Google review volume was the measure most closely tied to being named, and the Google rating ran slightly negative once a winery cleared a floor.

July 23, 2026: Yelp licenses its reviews, photos and business data to OpenAI for use in ChatGPT. (Yahoo Finance)

Map-pack presence is measured separately from organic search, and the four platform listings became one point each. Ranking on the map and being named by an AI assistant are different results, so they are measured apart.

September 16, 2026: BrightLocal (200,085 searches): Maps rank does not carry over to the AI surfaces, and repeat runs share only 20 to 33% of the businesses named. (BrightLocal)

The website, direct-commerce and brand-consistency categories shrank to a small Citation Readiness category, an AI-Ready Booking & Buying category and a Profile Accuracy category. In our October driver test the three categories they replaced did not predict being named, and an outside test and Google's own guidance found schema markup and AI-specific markup made little difference.

Ahrefs (May 11, 2026) tracked 1,885 pages that AI already cited as they added schema markup, against 4,000 that did not, and found no gain in citations. Google's AI optimization guide (updated July 10, 2026) says Google Search ignores llms.txt files and that no AI-specific markup is needed. (ahrefs.com/blog/schema-ai-citations; developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide)

Bookable through a platform an AI assistant can act on is tracked, and not scored this quarter. No assistant's booking list is settled, and it cannot yet be detected reliably from outside.

August 10, 2026: Yelp restaurant booking and waitlists go live inside ChatGPT. (PPC Land)

Social is smaller, and engagement rate is no longer scored. Engagement rate ran against being named, because small accounts post high rates.

Reddit stays out of the rubric. Its weight in AI answers is not stable yet; it is measured once it is.

August 14, 2026: ChatGPT's Reddit citations fall about 73% (directional, 16 brands). (Otterly)

Tracked this quarter and not scored: Named on AI-cited pages, Bookable through an AI-connected platform and Business-type markup.

The Seven Categories

This report scores one thing: how findable and how convincing you are online. Its rubric has seven dimensions, and they are the seven below. If you have seen our website audit or our full business diagnostic, those are different instruments measuring different parts of the business, and they carry their own counts. Do not try to reconcile them with these.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Third-Party Presence (23 pts), do the lists, guides, and press that visitors and AI assistants read name you? Review Volume & Reputation (25 pts), how many people vouch for you, and are they still doing it? Search & Map Discovery (21 pts), when a visitor searches for wineries rather than for you by name, do you come up, in the results and on the map? AI-Ready Booking & Buying (14 pts), once someone has picked you, can they book, join, and buy without picking up the phone? Profile Accuracy (6 pts), does your Google profile state the right facts, and does Apple Maps agree? Citation Readiness (6 pts), when a search engine or AI assistant reads your site, can it get the facts out? Social (5 pts), does your Instagram confirm you're open, active, and worth visiting?

The seven categories are not a flat checklist. They fall into two halves, and we report each half on its own, because a winery can win one and still lose the other.

Discoverability ("where should I go?"): Third-Party Presence, Review Volume & Reputation, and Search & Map Discovery. Whether a visitor, or an AI assistant answering one, finds you before they have your name. Most of the points sit here, because this is where our own test found the signals that go with being named, and most of the work here happens off your own website.

Conversion ("book it, reserve, show up"): AI-Ready Booking & Buying, Profile Accuracy, Citation Readiness, and Social. Whether the visitor who found you can confirm the facts, book, join, and buy. Most of these are one-time fixes.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

A winery strong on Conversion and weak on Discoverability gets one clear instruction: the gap is off your own site.

Dimension	What We Measure & Why	Max	County Avg	% of Max
Third-Party Presence	Who else says you are worth visiting. Scored on: named on best-of lists (14 pts), regional tourism and trade directories (4 pts), editorial and press mentions (5 pts).	23	7.0	31%
Review Volume & Reputation	The pre-planner's starting point. Volume and recent reviews count; a high rating on a handful of reviews no longer carries the category. Scored on: google review count (12 pts), yelp review count (5 pts), tripadvisor review count (4 pts), reviews in the last 90 days (3 pts), google rating floor (1 pts).	25	7.6	30%
Search & Map Discovery	The searches a visitor types before they have your name. Scored on: organic discovery-search presence (10 pts), map-pack presence (6 pts), owns its brand search (1 pts), listed on google (1 pts), listed on apple maps (1 pts), listed on yelp (1 pts), listed on tripadvisor (1 pts).	21	6.2	30%
AI-Ready Booking & Buying	Where an interested visitor either completes or leaks away. Scored on: online reservations (3 pts), club signup within 2 clicks (2 pts), modern checkout (1 pts), ships direct (1 pts), states shipped to (1 pts), visit page (1 pts), hours published on the site (1 pts), tasting fee published on a tasting page (2 pts), shipping cost visible (1 pts), store size (1 pts).	14	9.0	64%
Profile Accuracy	The facts a map or an assistant repeats about you. Scored on: google profile claimed (0.6 pts), google primary category correct (0.6 pts), google hours complete (0.6 pts), google profile links the website (0.6 pts), google attributes set (0.6 pts), apple and google agree on phone (1 pts), apple and google agree on address (1 pts), google secondary categories (1 pts).	6	4.6	77%
Citation Readiness	Your own site is one place answers get their facts. Scored on: serves our crawler (0.5 pts), robots.txt allows ai search bots (0.5 pts), store page readable without javascript (0.75 pts), store prices readable without javascript (0.75 pts), club page readable without javascript (0.75 pts), club prices readable without javascript (0.75 pts), tasting notes (0.5 pts), substantive pages (0.5 pts), mobile friendly (0.5 pts), page speed (lcp) (0.5 pts).	6	4.3	72%
Social	Instagram is likely how many wine country visitors check their shortlist. Scored on: instagram followers (3 pts), posted in the last 30 days (2 pts).	5	2.5	51%

Score bands are the ranges shown in the Score Distribution: labels for where a score sits, not separate scores. The cut-offs are set against the measured field, so Mid-pack is the band that holds the median winery.

Scoring Methodology

Every winery is evaluated on the seven categories described in this section. All data is collected from publicly accessible sources: no surveys, no self-reporting, no private analytics access. Scores reflect what a potential visitor actually encounters when searching for, evaluating, or trying to buy from your winery online.

The benchmark is not a fixed list. Since the Q2 2026 edition, 14 wineries entered our census and 12 left it, moving the county total from 171 to 172.

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

Of those 12 departures, 4 closed permanently. The other 8 are still operating businesses that no longer meet the criteria for this list: one entry per winery brand, a winery of its own, and direct sales to the public in the county.

One winery changed its name and appears here under the new one; it is counted once.

We report those numbers separately on purpose. A closure says something about the market. A winery leaving because it no longer fits the list says something about the list, and reading the second as the first would overstate how much of the county is in trouble.

Disclaimer: Scores in this report are based on publicly available data collected via automated tools. While we strive for accuracy, some data points may be incomplete or reflect temporary conditions. This report is provided for informational purposes and does not constitute professional advice. Scores may change as data collection methods improve.

Advice: Anything here about platform policy or shipping is general information based on our reading of published rules, not legal advice. DTC wine shipping in particular is permit-dependent and varies by destination state. Confirm with your own counsel before changing practice.

Company names, trademarks, and brand identities referenced in this report are the property of their respective owners. This report is independent analysis and is not endorsed or sponsored by any company named herein.

Each winery is measured at one location. At least four Central Coast brands operate two tasting rooms; a score describes the location measured, not every room.

Where to Go from Here

Our job starts with intelligence: the read across the cohort, the diagnostic on your own winery, and the order to fix things in. A sharp outside read matters most on the slow dimensions, and if you want more than the read, we can guide your team through the work itself.

Every winery in this report was scored using the same framework, by the same method, against the same peer set. That work happens every month whether you subscribe or not. What changes when you join Monitor is that you see it when we do: your own scorecard each month, and the Drift Watch alerts, which fire when your search and AI visibility, your reputation, your site's reachability to crawlers, your schema, or your social posting moves against you, the month it moves rather than the quarter after.

With Monitor Plus you widen that watch to four peers you name, and hear it when one of them passes you.

See your own winery, every month

This report reads the whole county. Monitor reads your winery: your own scorecard every month, and the Drift Watch alerts the month something moves against you. Monitor Plus adds four peers you name, so you hear when one of them passes you. If you would rather talk it through first, [book a 30-minute call](#).

Monitor and Monitor Plus: mainstreetiq.com/wineries | scott@mainstreetiq.com

Book a 30-minute call: calendly.com/scott_mainstreetiq/30min

About Main Street IQ

Main Street IQ gives businesses the kind of rigorous outside analysis that used to be reserved for companies big enough to hire a consulting firm. For wineries, that means an honest read on where you stand against the cohort, which gaps are most likely to be costing you visits and club signups, and a clear order to fix them in. We use AI to do much of the reading and counting, which is how the analysis stays thorough and the cost stays within reach of a working winery.

Scott Hess, who founded the practice, spent twenty years in finance and operations before it. Much of that was in corporate finance at Northern Trust, supporting the leadership of the business, and embedded with luxury and owner-operated brands where the founder still makes every call that matters. The lesson carried across all of it: what decides whether a business grows is usually visible from the outside long before it surfaces in the ledger, and the owner is the last person with time to go looking for it. That is the gap this practice was built to close.

Scott Hess | Founder | scott@mainstreetiq.com | mainstreetiq.com/wineries

Sources

[1] Santa Barbara County Agricultural Commissioner. Crop & Livestock Report 2025 (the county crop report), June 23, 2026, wine grapes. <https://content.civicplus.com/api/assets/744b727b-969f-45fd-a5a1-3d372dfc4f4f>

[2] Santa Barbara County Wine Improvement District. FY 2026-27 Annual Report, p. 2 (PDF p. 4). Santa Barbara County Board of Supervisors, file 26-00813, Attachment A, September 1, 2026. <https://legistar1.granicus.com/SantaBarbara/attachments/5638b8a9-0b3c-4312-8476-a7a3341607a3.pdf>

[3] McMillan, Rob. 2026 State of the U.S. Wine Industry Report. Silicon Valley Bank (First Citizens Bank), January 2026, pp. 4, 5, 16, 27, 35-36, 39. <https://www.firstcitizens.com/commercial/insights/industry-expertise/wine-report>

SAMPLE EDITION | Q3 2026 Santa Barbara County | Winery names and per-winery figures are illustrative

[4] McMillan, Rob. 2026 Direct-to-Consumer Wine Report. Silicon Valley Bank (First Citizens Bank), June 2026, pp. 19-26.
<https://www.firstcitizens.com/commercial/insights/industry-expertise/dtc-report>

[5] Visit SLO CAL. Business & Marketing Plan FY 27, July 2026, pp. 29-31: 2025 Visitor Profile Study by Heart + Mind Strategies, an online survey of 3,000 travelers across California and key fly markets, July 10 to August 4, 2025. https://assets.simpleviewinc.com/simpleview/image/upload/v1/clients/slocal/VSC_BusinessMarketingPlan_FY27_55db8e6b-3ada-4c0e-b836-08da375072ce.pdf

[6] MMGY Travel Intelligence. Portrait of American Travelers, Summer 2026. Release, July 9, 2026; interviews with 4,371 U.S. adults, May 2026.
<https://mmgyintel.com/travelers-are-redefining-value-as-competition-for-every-trip-intensifies-according-to-new-mmgy-research/>